

Weekly Self-Study Tasks to Complete

Introduction to Node.js and Express for Leaders

This document covers all of Week 2 of Phase 3 in the 4-hour Leaders model: 2 hours of instructor-led session, 1 hour of self-study video, and 1 hour of hands-on lab. The Core Resources table below fits inside the 1-hour self-study media budget. The Practice Activities section points to the Evergreen Insurance Quote API lab, where you will build a small Node.js and Express server. Additional Content at the end is optional and sits outside the 4-hour budget.

Core Resources (~60 min)

Watch the two Pluralsight modules called out below, not the entire course. Keep a terminal open as you watch so you can try the node commands the videos show.

Topic	Material Description	Est. Time	Link / Reference
Node.js Introduction	Node.js: Getting Started (Samer Buna, Pluralsight, updated Jan 07, 2026; 3h 30m course). Watch the "Introduction" module (~25 min): what Node is, why server-side JavaScript matters, and where it fits.	~25 min	pluralsight.com – Node.js: Getting Started
Getting Started with Node	Same Pluralsight course. Watch the "Getting Started with Node" module (~33 min): running Node from the command line, the REPL, and executing your first scripts.	~33 min	pluralsight.com – Node.js: Getting Started

Practice Activities (1 hour)

Complete this week's hands-on lab: "Evergreen Insurance Quote API: Building a Server with Node and Express." You will build a small API with GET and POST routes and a 404 handler, then test it with curl. The whole exercise takes about one hour.

In the lab you will:

- Open the Labfiles/evergreen-quote-express-api folder, run npm install, then npm start.
- Confirm the server is up by opening the health-check route in the browser.
- Add GET /api/quotes to return the list of quotes and test it with curl.
- Add GET /api/quotes/:id using req.params, returning 404 when the id is missing.
- Add POST /api/quote that reads req.body, validates it, calculates a premium, and returns 201.
- Add a catch-all 404 handler after the routes and confirm why ordering matters.

The lab instructions (with “Why this matters” callouts throughout) are in the lab environment. Budget one hour and work at your own pace.

Additional Content (Optional)

The following resources are optional and recommended for students who want to go deeper beyond the core curriculum. They are outside the 4-hour weekly budget. APIs and GraphQL, databases, and deployment build on this server in the coming weeks, so focus this week on Node basics, routes, and middleware.

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
Node.js	Node.js Essential Training (LinkedIn Learning) — a complete course covering the runtime, modules, npm, and building servers (Video Course).	linkedin.com/learning — Node.js Essential Training
Express	Express documentation — the authoritative guide to routing, middleware, and the request/response API (Reference).	expressjs.com
Node Reference	Node.js official documentation and Guides — the authoritative reference for built-in modules and the runtime (Reference).	nodejs.org — Learn

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
REST APIs	MDN "An overview of HTTP" — methods, status codes, and headers that every API uses (Tutorial).	developer.mozilla.org — HTTP overview
Practice	The Odin Project — NodeJS path. Free, hands-on lessons for leaders who want to build more servers (Interactive).	theodinproject.com — NodeJS